

# Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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## Identification

**Suggested name:** Kidney

**Suggested keywords:** renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; test

**Suggested category:** People & Body - body-parts

**Suggested sort location:** Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

## Required Example Images

| Size  | Color                                                                               | Black and white                                                                      |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 18x18 |  |   |
| 72x72 |  |  |

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## Factors for Inclusion

### A. Multiple meanings

Beyond the organ, kidney-shaped is an established shape descriptor in ordinary non-medical English. It names a recognized form in furniture and landscape design: kidney tables, kidney desks,

kidney trays, and kidney-shaped swimming pools. Retail and design catalogues use the term as a primary product category rather than as a figure of speech; see [1stDibs kidney-shaped tables](#) and [Houzz kidney-shaped pools](#).

This sense is not marginal relative to the literal ones the proposal relies on. In the English Google Books corpus, `kidney-shaped` reaches a higher historical peak than `kidney stone` and remains at roughly two-thirds of its 2022 level. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query](#).

A Kidney character therefore carries an organ sense and a widely used shape sense. The shape sense is offered as an additional meaning, not as the basis for encoding.

## B. Use in sequences

Two short combinations express established phrases:

- Kidney + rock: `kidney stone`.
- Kidney + test tube: `kidney tests` or `kidney function tests`.

MedlinePlus uses `kidney stone analysis` for a patient collecting a passed stone for a provider or laboratory, and lists `kidney tests`, `kidney function tests`, and `kidney panel` as established names for blood, urine, and imaging checks. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#) and [Kidney Tests](#).

## C. Breaks new ground

**Yes.** The [current Unicode Emoji List](#) has no Kidney character, and the current English CLDR annotations associate `kidney` with exactly one emoji:

```
<annotation cp="🫘">beans | food | kidney | legume | small</annotation>
```

That character is U+1FAD8 BEANS. Its CLDR short name is `beans`, and it remains a Food & Drink pictograph. CLDR documents character keywords as words or short phrases used to search for an emoji. The present data therefore connects the organ term to a food pictograph while providing no encoded Kidney character. See the [CLDR English annotations](#) and [CLDR emoji names and keyword guidance](#).

Changing that annotation alone cannot fill the representation gap. Removing `kidney` from Beans would stop the misleading association, but a user searching for `kidney` would still have no recognizable kidney-organ pictograph to find. Encoding Kidney supplies the missing character and allows the term to be associated with the organ it names. Generic medical emoji add care or testing but do not supply that literal noun.

## D. Distinctiveness

Kidney is shown as two maroon, inward-facing forms with visible medial notches and a clear diagonal offset. The polished 72-pixel example adds restrained shading and the renal vessels; the

purpose-built 18-pixel example keeps only the two solid notched bodies and the offset, which are the cues that survive at that size. Those cues distinguish it from separate Beans and from the symmetric lobes and top-entering airway of Lungs. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomical detail while preserving the paired notched bodies and the offset.

## **E. Expected usage level**

The five required frequency exhibits provide this proposal's primary empirical evidence of expected usage. They test the exact proposed name, `kidney`, in Google Search, Google Video Search, Google Trends Web Search, Google Trends Image Search, and Google Books Ngram Viewer. The Trends and Books exhibits compare `kidney` with `elephant` as instructed. Together, the five independent sources show sustained current and historical use of the proposed name. The cited message contexts below connect that name-level evidence to concrete uses for the character.

The search data is reinforced by evidence that people already try to communicate the organ pictographically. Lacking a Kidney character, writers substitute Beans: third-party emoji reference sites index Beans combinations under kidney and nephrology headings, and practitioners report that the substitution is confusing in the context of kidney disease. This is contextual evidence of the representation problem, not a substitute for the required frequency measurements. See [Kidney emoji combinations](#) and [The Case for a Kidney Emoji](#).

Kidney supplies the missing noun in ordinary messages about a stone, test results, dialysis, a transplant, or living donation. U.S. patient guidance uses the exact phrases `kidney stone`, `kidney tests`, `kidney transplant`, and `donate a kidney`; U.K. guidance likewise uses `kidney transplant tests` and explains dialysis when kidneys can no longer filter normally. These are concrete situations in which people collect a stone, discuss results, prepare for treatment, or donate or receive an organ; this is not an argument from medical importance. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#), [Kidney Tests](#), [Kidney Transplant](#), [Living Donation](#), [Kidney Transplant Tests](#), and [Dialysis](#).

## Google Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Web Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 211,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducibl e Google Search query.](#)

Google

kidney

×

🔊

🔄

🔍

⚙️

📱

Sign in

AI Mode

All

Images

Videos

Shopping

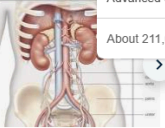
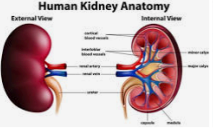
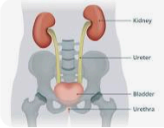
News

Short videos

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🌟 AI Overview



Kidneys are **two bean-shaped organs, about the size of a fist, located on either side of the spine just below the rib cage.** They filter roughly 37 gallons of blood daily to remove waste and extra water, maintaining fluid, salt, and mineral balance while producing urine. Key functions also include regulating blood pressure, stimulating red blood cell production, and managing bone health. [Cleveland Clinic](#) +4

**Key Kidney Functions & Health**

- **Filtration:** Using millions of tiny units called nephrons, kidneys filter waste and excess water from the blood, which then travels to the bladder through ureters.

Show more ▾

About 211,000,000 results (0.16s)

n, Anatomy, Function & Health

Where are your kidneys located? Your kidneys sit just below your rib cage and in your lower back. Typically...

[Cleveland Clinic](#)

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease At-a-Glance. Image. 1 in 3 adults in the U.S. are at risk for kidney disease. Image. 90K people...

[National Kidney Foundation](#)

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra wat...

[National Institutes of Health \(gov\)](#)



Cleveland Clinic

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/body/21824-kidney>

**Kidneys: Location, Anatomy, Function & Health**

Nov 5, 2025 — Your kidneys are organs that filter your blood. They remove waste and balance your body's fluids, among other tasks. Most people have one kidney ... [Read more](#)



People also ask

What are the first signs of a kidney problem?

What is the best drink to flush your kidneys?

What are the three early warning signs of a kidney?

What drinks are hardest on the kidneys?

4 of 9

## Google Video Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Video Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 66,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Video Search query.](#)

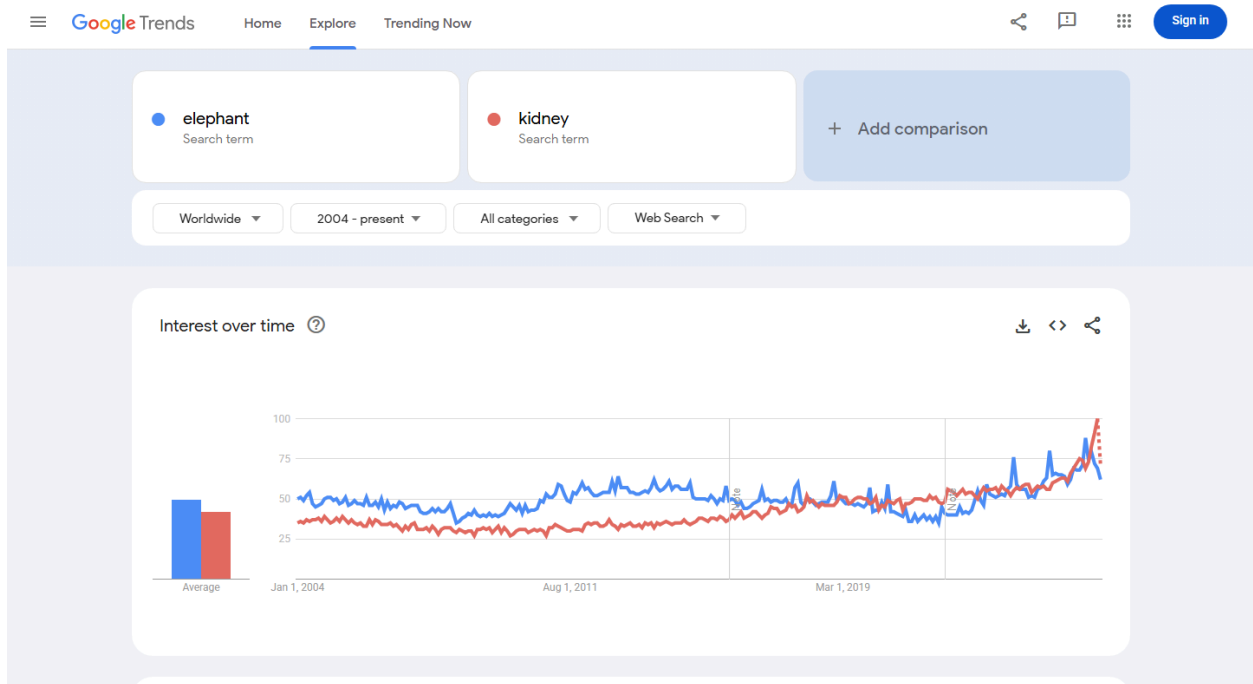
The screenshot shows the Google Video Search interface. At the top, the Google logo is on the left, and the search bar contains the word "kidney". To the right of the search bar are icons for a close button, voice search, image search, and a magnifying glass. Further right are settings, grid, and sign-in buttons. Below the search bar is a navigation bar with links to "All Mode", "All", "Images", "News", "Videos" (which is highlighted), "Shopping", "Books", "More", and "Tools".

The search results are listed below the navigation bar. Each result includes a thumbnail, a title, a description, and the source. A dropdown menu is open over the first result, showing filters: "Any duration", "Any time", "Any quality", "All videos", "Any source", and "Advanced Search". At the bottom of the dropdown, it says "About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)".

- Result 1:** Title: "How Do Kidneys Work?". Description: "For more information about the function of kidneys, please https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3 Your kidneys are your body's cle...". Source: "YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024".
- Result 2:** Title: "Get to Know Your Kidneys". Description: "Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ...". Source: "YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024".
- Result 3:** Title: "Kidney Function". Description: "KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ...". Source: "YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025".
- Result 4:** Title: "How Your Kidneys Work". Description: "MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall.". Source: "YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024".
- Result 5:** Title: "How kidneys work". Description: "How kidneys work – Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine.". Source: "Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021".
- Result 6:** Title: "Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease". Description: "Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ...". Source: "YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021".

## Google Trends - Web Search

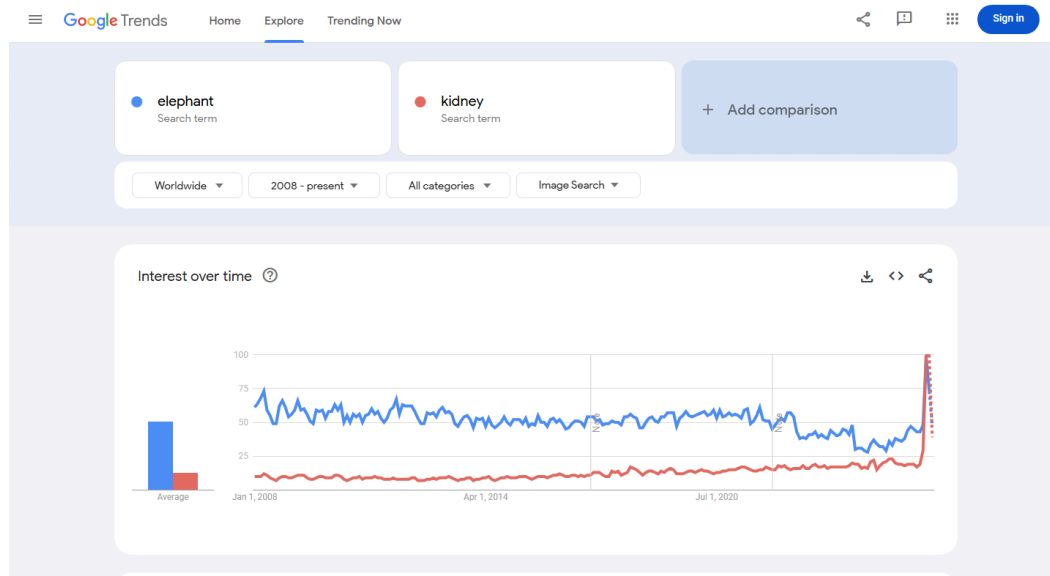
Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Elephant has the higher historical average; kidney remains sustained and reaches comparable or greater interest in recent periods. [Open the reproducible Google Trends Web Search query.](#)



## Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Kidney shows sustained image-search interest but remains below elephant for most of the displayed range.

[Open the reproducible Google Trends Image Search query.](#)



## Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query.](#)



## F. Completeness

Not applicable. Internal organs are not a fixed set.

## G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on compatibility with a popular existing system. The separate CLDR search mismatch is addressed under Breaks new ground and Already representable.

## Factors for Exclusion

### A. Already representable

Beans is the strongest existing single emoji, and it is already being used this way. Unicode's own `kidney` keyword makes Beans searchable under the organ term, but searchability is not representation: the result is still a food pictograph. Writers who need the organ reach for it in the absence of anything better. Third-party emoji reference sites independently index Beans combinations under kidney and nephrology headings; see [Kidney emoji combinations](#) and [Nephrology emoji](#). A 2022 editorial in the American Journal of Kidney Diseases describes Beans as among the best available alternatives and reports that it is confusing when used in the context of kidney disease; several authors of that editorial are also submitters here, so it is offered as practitioner testimony rather than independent measurement. See [The Case for a Kidney Emoji](#).

That is the substance of this factor. The question is not whether a substitute can be improvised; it is whether the improvisation works. Beans is named `beans`, is categorized under Food & Drink, and displays food. Beans + Hospital can suggest kidney care but can equally read as food, diet, or beans at a hospital. Beans + Rock does not clearly name `kidney stone`, and Beans + Test Tube does not clearly name `kidney tests`; in each case the reader must first assume that Beans means an organ. Observed substitution shows the need; the recorded confusion shows the substitute does not meet it. Removing the `kidney` annotation would stop that misleading search result, but would not make the organ representable. A Kidney character supplies the missing noun. See the [Unicode Emoji List](#).

### B. Overly specific

Kidney represents the organ generally. The same noun is used in kidney stone analysis, kidney testing, dialysis, transplantation, and living donation; it is not a specific disease, procedure, campaign, organization, or subtype.

### C. Open-ended

Kidney is not proposed as the first member of an anatomy-completion project. It clears four independent filters: the required five-source frequency evidence; the failure of Beans or a short sequence to identify the organ; established stone, testing, dialysis, donation, and transplant messages that need the noun; and a paired notched form that remains recognizable at 18x18 pixels. An adjacent organ would have to establish its own evidence under every selection factor. Encoding



Kidney therefore does not create an automatic series or establish that another organ meets the same threshold.

#### **D. Transient**

Kidney is an established anatomical term rather than a campaign, event, or product. The embedded Google Books evidence spans 1500-2022, while current NIDDK, MedlinePlus, and HRSA guidance uses the same noun across testing, stones, dialysis, transplantation, and donation.

#### **E. Faulty comparison**

Existing organ emoji do not create an entitlement to Kidney. Lungs is used only as a small-size legibility comparison; the Kidney case rests on the named stone, testing, dialysis, transplant, and donation messages, the remaining ambiguity of Beans, the frequency evidence, and the paired notched pictograph.

### **Other Information**

The singular name Kidney identifies the organ concept even though the example shows the familiar paired organs; this proposal does not request separate singular and plural characters. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomy while preserving two inward-facing notched bodies and a visible offset. Vascular anatomy is intentionally omitted from the 18x18 examples, where it does not survive, and retained in the 72x72 examples.

Official guidance: [Unicode Emoji Proposals](#).